

Punctuation Mastery

Master the rules, avoid common traps, and boost your writing skills for the big test.



Accuracy



Confidence



Speed

INTERACTIVE LESSON READY



Why Punctuation Matters

✗ Without Punctuation

1 "Let's eat Grandma"



Crucial Mistake!

This implies you are going to **eat your grandmother** for dinner.

✓ With Punctuation

2 "Let's eat, Grandma"



Crystal Clear

The comma shows you are **speaking to** your grandmother.



BENEFIT 1

Changes Meaning

BENEFIT 2

Improves Clarity

BENEFIT 3

Earns Easy Marks

Lesson Goals

By the end of this session, you will be able to:



KNOWLEDGE

Understand rules



ANALYSIS

Spot errors



CORRECTION

Fix sentences



REFINEMENT

Edit paragraphs



STRATEGY

Avoid common traps



Target Score

"Practice makes progress"

Sentence End Marks



Full Stop

STATEMENT

Used at the end of a complete thought or telling sentence.

"I like apples."



Question Mark

INQUIRY

Used when asking something or seeking information.

"Do you like apples?"



Exclamation Mark

STRONG FEELING

Used to show excitement, anger, or loud shouting.

"I love apples!"



Pro Tip: Use only one end mark per sentence. Multiple marks (!!!) are incorrect in formal writing.

Capital Letters



Essential for proper nouns & starts

THE 4 GOLDEN RULES



Start of Sentences

Always capitalize the first letter of every sentence.

The dog ran.



Names (Proper Nouns)

Names of specific people and pets.

Ava, Mr Chen



Places

Specific cities, countries, streets, and landmarks.

Sydney, Perth



Days & Months

Names of days, months, and holidays.

Monday, June

SEE IT IN ACTION

✗ INCORRECT

i went to sydney

Missing sentence start

Missing place name



✓ CORRECT

I went to Sydney

Notice how both the **start** and the **place name** are capitalized.

Commas in Lists



The Rule of Three

Use commas to separate items in a list of **3 or more** things.

I bought  **apples** ,  **bananas** ,  **and grapes** .



WITHOUT COMMAS (CONFUSING)

I bought apples bananas and grapes.

Looks like a mashed-up fruit salad!



THE "OXFORD COMMA"

The comma before "**and**" is optional, but we recommend using it to keep your meaning crystal clear!



Commas After Starters

THE STARTER FORMULA

STEP 1

Starter Phrase

INTRO



STEP 2

/



STEP 3

Main Clause

SENTENCE

EXAMPLES

1

After school, we played.

Tells us "When"

2

Before dinner, I finished homework.

Tells us "When"

3

In the morning, Mia reads.

Tells us "When"

Extra Information **Commas**

”

i

The "Drop-in" Rule

Use a pair of commas to surround **extra information**. If you remove it, the sentence still makes sense.

SENTENCE STRUCTURE BREAKDOWN



ESSENTIAL SENTENCE



EXTRA DETAIL (REMOVABLE)



THE "HANDLES"

Joining Ideas



Complete Sentence 1

"I wanted to go"

Comma goes
here!

but

Complete Sentence 2

"it rained."

I wanted to go, **but** it rained.



Joining Words (Conjunctions)

Use a comma before these words when connecting two full sentences:

and

but

or

so

yet



The "Because" Trap



I stayed inside **because** it rained.

No comma in the middle!



Although it rained, we played.

Comma needed if starter comes first.

Apostrophes: Contractions

An **apostrophe (')** takes the place of the missing letter(s).

can ~~not~~



can't

missing: n, o

it ~~is~~



it's

missing: i

do ~~not~~



don't

missing: o

they ~~are~~



they're

missing: a

we ~~will~~



we'll

missing: w, i

I ~~am~~



I'm

missing: a

Apostrophes: Possession



Shows ownership or belonging

THE 4 OWNERSHIP RULES



Singular Owner

Add 's to words not ending in s.

the dog's bone



Plural ending in s

Add only an apostrophe ' after the s.

students' books



Irregular Plurals

If plural doesn't end in s, add 's.

children's games



Names ending in s

Add 's (easiest) or just '.

James's car

WHERE DOES THE APOSTROPHE GO?

✓ ONE OWNER



The girl's hat

The hat belongs to one girl.

vs

✓ MANY OWNERS

The girls' hats

The hats belong to many girls.



It's VS Its



It's

CONTRACTION

Short for **it is** or **it has**.

💡 The Test: Can you replace it with "it is"?

EXAMPLES

It's raining outside.

→ *It is raining outside.*

It's been a long day.

→ *It has been a long day.*

VS



Its

POSSESSIVE

Shows **ownership** or belonging.

💡 The Test: Like "his" or "her" (no apostrophe).

EXAMPLES

The dog wagged **its** tail.

→ *Belonging to the dog.*

The tree lost **its** leaves.

→ *Belonging to the tree.*

Speech Marks



The Rule of 66 and 99

Use quotation marks (speech marks) around the **exact words** spoken.



Sam

Inside the quotes!

"I am hungry," said Sam.



Mum

"Stop!" shouted Mum.



GOLDEN RULE

Punctuation (, . ! ?) belongs inside the speech marks.

Dialogue Order



1

Speech First

START WITH THE WORDS

The quote comes **before** the speaker tag.

- i** Rule: Use a comma inside the closing speech marks (unless it's ? or !).

EXAMPLE

"Let's go," said Tom.

1 Open speech → 2 Comma inside → 3 Tag



2

Speaker First

START WITH THE PERSON

The speaker tag comes **before** the quote.

- i** Rule: Comma after the tag, then start speech with a Capital Letter.

EXAMPLE

Tom said, "Let's go."

1 Tag → 2 Comma → 3 Open speech



Both patterns are correct! Choose one and stick to the rules.

↓ NEW SPEAKER = NEW LINE



Common NAPLAN Traps



Missing Capitals

Forgetting to capitalize the start of sentences or proper nouns (names, places).

✗ i went to perth



Comma Splice

Using a comma instead of a full stop to join two complete sentences.

✗ I ran fast, I won.



Run-on Sentences

Letting sentences run together without any punctuation at all.

✗ He sat down he ate.



Wrong Apostrophes

Confusing *it's/its* or using apostrophes for plurals.

✗ apple's for sale



Speech Errors

Forgetting punctuation inside the speech marks or missing the new line.

✗ "Hi" said Tom



STRATEGY

Double-check your writing for these 5 specific traps before you finish!

Spot the Mistake



THE CHALLENGE

my friend sam said lets play soccer
tomorrow

1

Check Capitals

Look for sentence starters and names.

2

Check Punctuation

Is someone speaking? Is anything missing?

 Hide Answer

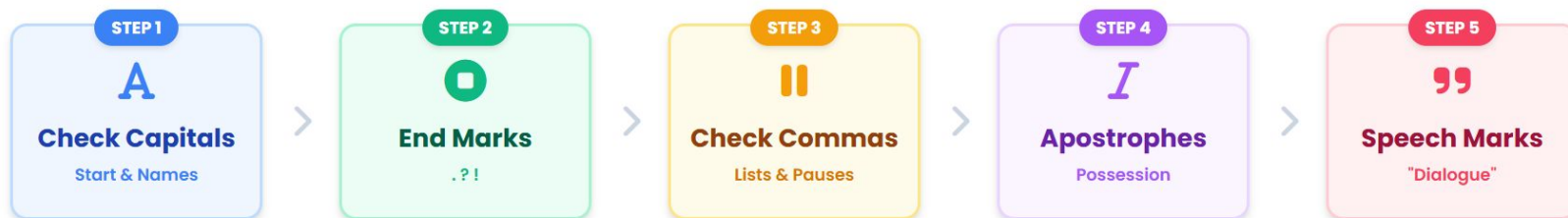
CORRECTED SENTENCE

My friend Sam said, "Let's play soccer tomorrow



The 5-Step Editing Strategy

FOLLOW THIS SEQUENCE FOR EVERY SENTENCE



Why this order works?

Checking one type of punctuation at a time prevents your brain from getting overwhelmed. Don't try to fix everything at once!

✓ Quick Check

PASS 1
Sentence
Boundaries

PASS 2
Internal
Punctuation

PASS 3
Details &
Spelling



FAST TRACK

Don't waste time on tiny details first. Go for the big wins.

Fix sentence boundaries first.

Most marks are lost on run-on sentences. Quickly scan for long strings of words and break them apart.



~~We ran fast we won the game~~



We ran fast. We won the game.

RESULT

Instantly fixes **80%** of common punctuation errors.

Guided Practice



THE SENTENCE

yesterday we went to melbourne it was
fun

1

Fix Capital Letters

Capitalise the first word and the city name.

2

Separate Ideas

These are two separate thoughts. Split them up.

 **Reveal Answer**

Challenge Practice



CORRECT THE SENTENCE

wow that was amazing said lucy

1

Interjections

Strong feeling words like "Wow" usually need a comma after them.

2

Speech Tag

Separate what is said from who said it. Don't forget capital letters for names!

 Reveal Answer

Expert Practice



THE CHALLENGE SENTENCE

when we arrived dad said hurry up we dont have
time

1 Structure

Introductory phrase needs a comma. Split the two spoken sentences.

2 Dialogue

Add speech marks around what Dad said. Don't forget the comma before speech.

3 Mechanics

Capitalise names and sentence starts. Fix the contraction for "do not".

 **Reveal Answer**

Success Checklist



Click each item you have mastered:



I can use **capitals** for names and sentence starts.



I can end sentences correctly (. ? !).



I can use **commas** in lists and after starters.



I can use **apostrophes** for contractions & possession.



I can punctuate **speech** with quotation marks.



Your Progress



5 of 5 completed

Check off each skill as you master it.
Aim for 100% readiness!



You are Ready!
Great job on mastering punctuation.

Final Motivation



Experts Score Higher

Mastering punctuation is the easiest way to boost your writing marks.



Careful Writers Win

Taking a moment to check your work separates good writers from great ones.



Accuracy Beats Speed

It's better to write one correct sentence than two confusing ones.

NAPLAN PREPARATION COMPLETE

You Are Ready.

Good Luck! 👍